

strength not through a publisher-provided platform, but because of a resonating voice that compels attention. These blogs will inspire ideas and in turn, influence decisions, giving more individuals in a business setting strength and influence.

Periods of rapid change unleash new forces that Harvard Business School Professor Clayton M. Christensen termed “disruptive technologies” in his 1997 book, *The Innovator’s Dilemma*. Already a new and emerging technology, weblogs have potential to be a disruptive technology. Their self-publishing advantages are changing how individuals and companies are digitally communicating and collaborating. They make the amount of time and money companies now invest in traditional online development seem excessive and wasteful. And they’re making a lot of webmasters nervous. If anyone can build, populate and update a weblog, what does that mean to the future of conventional web development?

Small companies can design and deploy a weblog in a matter of days without incurring outside resource costs. CNET Radio, an all talk, all technology radio station in the Bay Area, uses a weblog to extend the audience experience to the Internet. CNET Radio’s weblog posts upcoming events, teases the next on-air topics and weekly posts its Free Plug Friday - a list of sponsors currently running radio commercials on the station. In addition to CNET, there is a growing core of companies that have started to use weblogs to strengthen communications with customers and constituents. In mid 2002, The New York Times posted its weblog, a continuously updated list of news headlines from around the world. Macromedia, the software maker of Flash and Cold Fusion began to use weblogs in the wake of multiple software releases so that it could effectively field questions and concerns from developers and customers. Other well-known companies that have begun to implement weblogs into their communications strategies are Shell, which has a weblog with forums dedicated to the environment, security, technology and society, Jupiter Media, which was the first to deploy weblogs for individual research analysts, and the Drudge Report, an online up-to-the-minute news source.